

D365 F&O

Explained Simply

Your first-week survival guide.

Dynamics 365 finance and operations apps: the words, the screen, the everyday tasks and the mistakes to avoid.

 Where F&O sits

 Key words

 The screen

 Finding things

 Journals

 Everyday tasks

 P2P & O2C

 Shortcuts

 Copilot

 Newbie mistakes

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Swipe →

Where F&O sits

Dynamics 365 is a family. Here's your branch.



F&O IN ONE SENTENCE

Microsoft's cloud ERP for larger organisations: it runs the money, stock, buying, selling, projects and people behind a business.

Finance and operations apps (ERP)

YOU ARE HERE



Finance

Ledgers, payables, receivables, budgets



Supply Chain Management

Stock, buying, warehouses, manufacturing



Commerce

Shops, tills and online retail



Project Operations

Projects, time, expenses, billing



Human Resources

Employees, leave, benefits

Customer engagement (CRM)

Sales, Customer Service, Field Service, Contact Center, Customer Insights (Data & Journeys, formerly Marketing)

Business Central

A separate all-in-one ERP for small and medium businesses. Different screens.

Names you'll hear: D365 F&O, D365FO, or 'AX' (the older Dynamics AX it grew from). Microsoft's own term is 'finance and operations apps'.



Words for getting around

What people mean when they say...

Legal entity **COMPANY**

A company inside F&O with its own books. Also called a company.

Think of it as: separate shops in one chain: each keeps its own till. You switch between them with the company picker.

Dashboard **HOME**

The first page you see, with a tile for each of your workspaces.

Think of it as: your phone's home screen: tap a tile to open that area of work.

Workspace **YOUR DESK**

A page built around one job, e.g. Vendor payments: tiles, lists, links.

Think of it as: a desk laid out for one task, with the to-do pile already sorted.

List page **THE DRAWER**

A grid of many records, e.g. All vendors or All purchase orders.

Think of it as: a filing-cabinet drawer: flick through, filter, then open one folder.

Details page **THE FOLDER**

Everything about one record, split into sections (FastTabs).

Think of it as: one opened folder. Edit it, or read it in view mode (F2 switches).



Words for what's on the screen

The parts of a page, and the work behind it

Action Pane **BUTTONS**

The strip of tabs and buttons across the top of a page.

Think of it as: the ribbon in Word or Excel. Can't find a button? Press Alt+Q to search for it.

FastTab **SECTION**

A section of a details page that expands and collapses.

Think of it as: an accordion folder: open only the pocket you need (General, Addresses...).

FactBox **SIDE FACTS**

A side panel of related facts about the selected record.

Think of it as: sticky notes on the side: balances, contacts, related documents.

Number sequence **AUTO IDS**

Hands out the next ID for vouchers, orders, vendors and more.

Think of it as: a raffle-ticket roll: every document gets the next number, in order.

Batch job **BACKGROUND**

A task that runs on the server, now or on a schedule.

Think of it as: a dishwasher on a timer: set it, walk away, check it's finished.



Money words

The finance vocabulary behind every posting

Main account CHART OF ACCOUNTS

One account in the chart of accounts, e.g. Office supplies.

Think of it as: a labelled pot that money goes in and out of.

Financial dimensions TAGS

Extra tags on a posting, such as Department or Cost centre.

Think of it as: hashtags for money, so reports can be sliced any way you need.

Journal DRAFT

A batch of lines you prepare, check and then post.

Think of it as: a draft: nothing reaches the ledger until it's posted.

Posting MAKE IT FINAL

Sends the entries to the ledger. Posted entries can't be deleted.

Think of it as: posting a letter. To undo it, you post a reversal.

Voucher RECEIPT NO.

The number that groups the lines of one posted transaction.

Think of it as: the receipt number you quote when asking 'what was this?'

Ledger period OPEN OR CLOSED

A slice of the fiscal year: Open, On hold or Permanently closed.

Think of it as: opening hours for posting. Closed means come back another day.

The F&O screen

A list page, labelled. Yours will look similar.



≡ Finance and Operations

Search for a page

2

GB01

Favourites

General journals

Recent

All vendors

Workspaces

Vendor payments

Modules

Accounts payable

General ledger

1

Vendor

Procurement

Invoice

Options

+ New

Edit

Delete

Transactions

5

All vendors

Filter

Filter by name...

6

Account	Name	Currency	On hold
1001	Contoso Office Ltd	GBP	Yes
1002	Fabrikam Supplies	GBP	No
1003	Northwind Parts	EUR	No
1004	Litware Logistics	GBP	No
1005	Tailspin Tools	USD	No
1006	Adatum Paper	GBP	No

7

Balance

£12,480.00

Open invoices

4 invoices

Contact

Accounts team

8

- 1

Navigation pane

Favourites, Recent, Workspaces, Modules.
- 2

Search for a page

Type a page name to jump there.
- 3

Company picker

The legal entity you're working in.
- 4

Copilot, alerts, settings

Top-right icons. Copilot if enabled.
- 5

Action Pane

Tabs and buttons for this page.
- 6

Filter pane & QuickFilter

Narrow the list down.
- 7

Grid

The list. Select a header to filter or sort.
- 8

FactBox pane

Related facts for the selected row.

Open any row to get its details page, split into FastTabs. Screens vary with your version, set-up and security role.

Finding things

Stop clicking through menus



Search for a page

Ctrl+/
⌘+⌵

Type a page name, e.g. 'general journals'. The fastest way to anywhere.

Favourites & Recent

Star a page in the navigation pane to keep it. Recent lists where you've been.

Filter pane

Ctrl+F3
⌘+F3

Filter a list page by several fields at once.

Column filter

Ctrl+G
⌘+G

Select a column header to filter or sort it, much like Excel.

Advanced filter or sort

Ctrl+Shift+F3
⌘+⇧+F3

For tricky filters and multi-column sorts. Save them to reuse.

Saved views

Save your filters and columns as a named view, and pin it as your default.

Company picker

Ctrl+Shift+O
⌘+⇧+O

Switch legal entity. Check it before you create or post anything.

Journals & vouchers

The finance tasks you'll do in week one



Create and post a general journal

- 1 Go to **General ledger** > **Journal entries** > **General journals**.
- 2 Select **New**, choose a journal **Name**, then select **Lines**.
- 3 Enter the date, **Account**, description and a **Debit** or **Credit**.
- 4 Add the **Offset account** (or more lines) so it balances.
- 5 Select **Validate**, fix any errors, then **Post**.

Needs approval? Use **Workflow** > **Submit**. Approvers open it from **Common** > **Work items** > **Work items assigned to me**.

Check (or reverse) a voucher

- 1 Go to **General ledger** > **Inquiries and reports** > **Voucher transactions**.
- 2 Filter by the voucher number or date to see every line.
- 3 Posted by mistake? Select it, then **Reverse**, with a date and a reason.

Golden rule: always Validate before you Post. Once posted, lines can't be edited or deleted, only reversed. Check the company picker first, too.



Look-ups, batch jobs & Excel

Answering 'where is it?' and 'has it run?'

See a vendor's or customer's transactions

- 1 Go to **Accounts payable** > **Vendors** > **All vendors** (or **Accounts receivable** > **Customers** > **All customers**).
- 2 Filter to find the vendor or customer and select the row.
- 3 On the Action Pane, open the **Vendor** (or **Customer**) tab and select **Transactions**.

Check a batch job

- 1 Go to **Common** > **Inquiries** > **Batch jobs** > **My batch jobs**.
- 2 Read the **Status**: Waiting, Executing, Ended, Error or Withhold.
- 3 Error? Open the job's history and log to see the message.

Get data into Excel

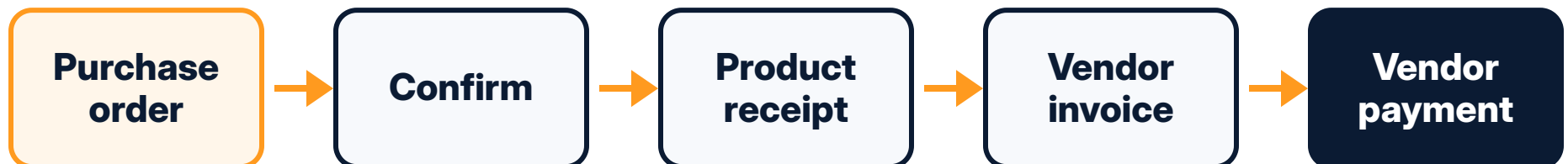
- 1 **Export to Excel** (Ctrl+Shift+E): a one-off copy of the grid.
- 2 **Open in Microsoft Office** > **Open in Excel**: a live link through the Excel add-in; some pages let you edit and publish back.

Two journeys to know

Where your documents fit end to end

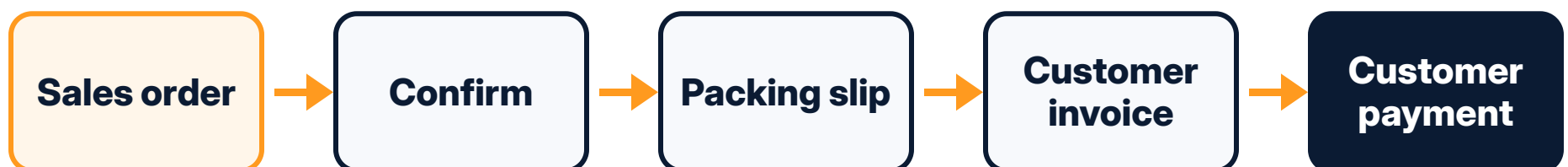


Procure-to-pay buying from vendors



Tip: the vendor invoice is usually matched to the order and receipt before it can be paid. Many firms add a purchase requisition first.

Order-to-cash selling to customers



Tip: the packing slip records the goods leaving; the customer invoice bills the customer and posts the revenue.

Create a purchase order (the short version)

- 1 Go to **Procurement and sourcing** > **Purchase orders** > **All purchase orders** and select **New**.
- 2 Pick the **Vendor account**, then add lines: item, quantity, price.
- 3 Confirm it (after approval, if your company uses workflow). Receipt and invoice follow later.

Keyboard shortcuts

Only ones Microsoft documents for F&O



GET AROUND

Ctrl+ / or **Alt+G**

Search for a page

Alt+Shift+Home

Go to the dashboard

Ctrl+Shift+0

Move to the company picker

Alt+F1

Open, pin or close the navigation pane

Ctrl+ ' or **Alt+Q**

Action search: find any button

WORK WITH RECORDS

Alt+N

Create a new record

Alt+S or **Ctrl+S**

Save the record

F2

Switch between view and edit mode

Ctrl+Shift+F5

Revert unsaved changes

Shift+F5

Refresh the data

T

In a date field: today's date

FIND & EXPORT

Ctrl+F3

Open the Filter pane

Ctrl+G

Filter the current column

Ctrl+Shift+E

Export to Excel

Lost? Press **Alt+Shift+K** on any page, or right-click a control and choose **View shortcuts**.

Copilot in F&O

AI help beside your work, if it's switched on



WHERE TO FIND IT

Look for the Copilot icon at the top of the page. It opens a chat pane on the right.

Copilot pane ALL F&O APPS

Ask how-to questions in plain English, e.g. 'How do I reverse a journal?' Answers come from Microsoft's docs, plus any your admins add.

Chat with your data ALL F&O APPS

Ask questions about F&O data, using only the data you already have access to.

Summaries FINANCE & SCM

AI summaries on pages such as Workflow history, the customer page and, in Supply Chain Management, pages like purchase orders.

Agents (preview) SELECTED APPS

Helpers such as the Account Reconciliation Agent and the Supplier Communications Agent. Mostly 'production ready preview' in 2026.

It depends on your set-up. Features vary with licence, region, version and what your admins turn on. Always check AI output before you post anything.

Newbie mistakes & fixes

Everyone makes these in week one



Posted in the wrong company

Fix: Check the company picker before you start. To fix it, reverse the entry and post it again in the right legal entity.



Trying to edit a posted journal

Fix: You can't edit or delete posted entries. Reverse the voucher, then post a corrected one.



'Period not open' errors

Fix: The ledger period is On hold or closed. Use a date in an open period, or ask finance to open it.



A menu or button is missing

Fix: Usually security, not a bug. Roles, duties and privileges decide what you see. Ask your admin.



Number sequence errors

Fix: The sequence for that document isn't set up, or has run out. An admin fixes it under Number sequences.



Financial dimension required

Fix: The account needs dimensions filled in, e.g. Department. Complete every segment of the account.



Batch job 'stuck'

Fix: Check its status. Withhold is paused on purpose; Waiting is queued. Check with the owner before re-running.

Found this **useful**?



Save it

Keep it handy for your first weeks in F&O.



Share it

Repost to help someone new to Dynamics 365.



Follow Subhash Sharma

For more plain-English tech guides.

About me: web developer from 1994 to 2016, now an application support and tech lead. I explain tech the way I wish someone had explained it to me.

Your screens may differ. Menus, buttons and paths vary with your version, configuration and security role.

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